CIRC HQ STUDENT HANDOUT | GRADES 5 AND 6

Outdoor Habitat Helper

Goal: Observe a local habitat need and design a safe, realistic helper for biodiversity, water, shelter, observation, or protective communication.

35 minutes | 9 steps | Engineering and Design, Library and Information Literacy | Playbook B meeting 31

Ask | Plan | Build | Test | Improve

You are done when

Show the observation, helper, benefit, risk, and the approval needed before any real-world action.

You will use

- Clipboards
- Local habitat photo cards
- Site map
- Cardboard
- Paper
- Craft sticks
- String
- Tape
- Rulers
- Approval checklist
- Scissors
- Approval tray

Steps

35 minutes total. Your teacher says when to move on.

1 Step 1: Get ready — 3 min

- Clip the site map to your board.
- Choose one observation zone.

2 Step 2: Walk out — 2 min

- Walk with your habitat team.

3 Step 3: Habitat safety — 4 min

- Observe wildlife without touching it.
- Leave nests, plants, droppings, or insects alone.
- Cut model parts only on the table.
- Keep fingers outside the cutting path.
- Install nothing outdoors.

4 Step 4: Record the need — 6 min

- Record one habitat observation.
- Name one need supported by that evidence.
- Mark the location on the map.

5 Step 5: Return inside — 2 min

- Walk back with your habitat team.
- Place the map at your seat.

6 Step 6: Plan a helper — 5 min

- Choose one helper type.
- List one benefit.
- List one risk.
- List one maintenance need.

7 Step 7: Build a small model — 6 min

- Cut only approved model pieces.
- Build the helper at table scale.
- Add one clear safety label.

8 Step 8: Pack the model — 3 min

- Close the scissors.
- Place the model in the approval tray.

9 Step 9: Exit check — 4 min

- Point to the evidence on your map.
- Explain why teacher approval is still needed.

What to turn in

Your observation, helper, benefit and risk.

No computer? Another way to do it

Use photo cards indoors.

Finished early? Next challenge

Season Check: Explain how the helper may need to change in winter, spring, summer, or fall.

Stay safe

Observe without touching wildlife, nests, insects, unknown plants, or droppings. No outdoor installation, food, water, digging, or attachment occurs without teacher approval.

Grade targets

Grade 5: Pick one habitat need and build one helper.
Grade 6: Name one risk and the approval needed before any real action.

Stuck? Try this order

1. Read the step again, out loud if you can.
2. Ask a partner at your table.
3. Raise your hand. Keep working on the next part while you wait.